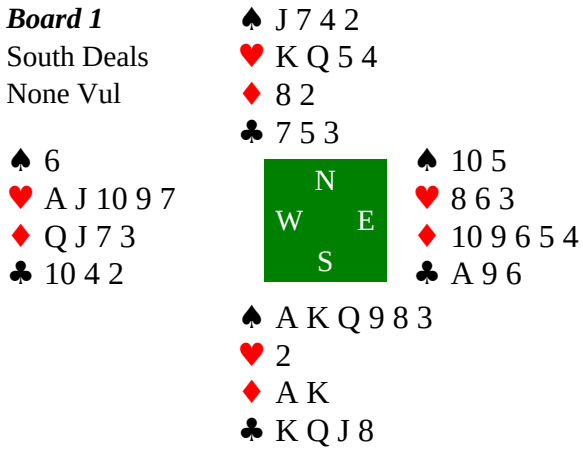
Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by South
Lead: ♦Q

NORTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince SOUTH to make a slam try.

SOUTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If NORTH shows one Ace SOUTH plans to bid 6♠, but when NORTH bids 5♣ SOUTH settles for 5♠

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 6 4 ♥ K J 9 ♦ A K Q J 9 ♣ K Q	
♠ K 9 8 7 5 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 7 6 5 4 ♣ A 6		♠ Q 10 2 ♥ 5 3 2 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 9 8 5 3 2
	♠ J 3 ♥ A Q 10 8 6 ♦ 10 3 ♣ J 10 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

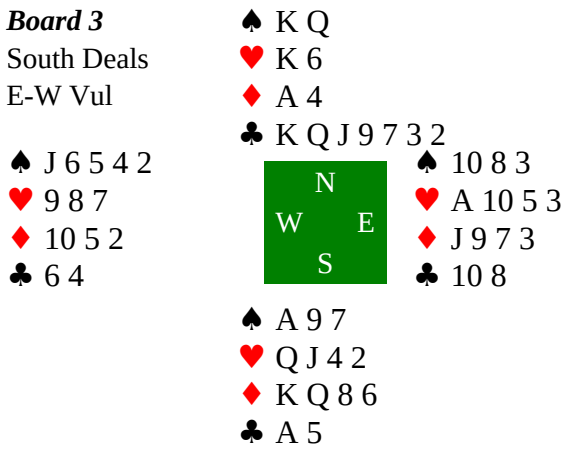
1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣A

SOUTH makes a positive 3♥ response to NORTH's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

NORTH only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the SOUTH hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠4

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made. SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

Board 4
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 9 5 2 ♥ A J 7 4 3 ♦ A Q ♣ 9 8	
♠ 8 ♥ Q 10 ♦ J 9 6 5 4 2 ♣ Q J 3 2		♠ 10 7 ♥ 9 8 6 2 ♦ 10 8 ♣ 10 7 6 5 4
	♠ A K Q 6 4 3 ♥ K 5 ♦ K 7 3 ♣ A K	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When NORTH supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that NORTH has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that NORTH will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 2 ♥ K Q 6 5 ♦ K Q J ♣ K J 6	
♠ 9 8 4 ♥ 4 3 ♦ A 7 6 4 ♣ 10 5 4 3	N W E S	♠ Q 10 6 5 ♥ 7 2 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ A 9 7 2
	♠ J 7 3 ♥ A J 10 9 8 ♦ 8 3 2 ♣ Q 8	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by South
Lead: ♦A

NORTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears SOUTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because SOUTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.